

Khadija Abdi

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Education

Cornell University

May 2028

Master of Science in Human Environment Relations, Environmental Psychology and Human Factors

Ithaca, NY

Research Focus: Equity in health sensor design (cross-skin-tone accuracy) and user trust in health technology

Relevant Coursework: Human Factors & Inclusive Design, Applied Ergonomic Methods, Research Methods, AI Embodiment & Design, Quantitative Methods I

University of Waterloo

May 2025

Bachelor of Applied Science in Chemical Engineering, Honours, Co-operative Program

Waterloo, ON

Technical Skills

Research Methods: Usability testing, user interviews, persona development, stakeholder mapping, secondary research/literature synthesis, research ethics protocols

Analysis & Programming: Python (pandas, NumPy), MATLAB, HTML, JavaScript, ReactJS, statistical and qualitative data analysis

Design & Visualization: AutoCAD, SolidWorks, Figma, Power BI

Work Experience

Research Fellow

August 2026 – Present

Health Design Innovations Lab (HDIL)

Ithaca, NY

- Recently joined the HDIL, a multidisciplinary lab in the Dept. of Design & Environmental Analysis researching how healthcare environment design and management can improve health outcomes and well-being.

User Experience Researcher

August 2025 – Present

Allshores Limited

Toronto, ON

- Mapped end-to-end workflows for **3 patient and provider audiences**, uncovering **10+ pain points** that informed feature prioritization for health-related services.
- Collaborated with Insights and Product teams to design and implement **5 feedback collection methods**, strengthening alignment across stakeholders.
- Synthesized findings into **5 user personas** and early Jobs To Be Done (JTBD) frameworks, delivering strategic insights that guided product roadmap decisions.

Co-Founder & Product Lead

October 2024 – June 2026

Mea (formerly Hera)

Waterloo, ON

- Built a digital support platform that addresses postpartum mental health through peer connection, emotion tracking, and a personalized care guide.
- Selected for the University of Waterloo's Velocity Summer Incubator, receiving venture funding, mentorship, and dedicated product development support.
- Led customer discovery and product validation through **1,000+ survey views** and **20+ interviews** with healthcare experts and target users, refining the roadmap through strategic mentorship and early advisor engagement.

Associate Product Management Intern

January 2024 – August 2024

The Argus Group

Hamilton, Bermuda

- Conducted usability testing and **30+ user interviews** across service and product research initiatives, applying triangulation of surveys, interviews, and observational data to identify navigation and lifecycle gaps.
- Owned end-to-end usability testing with **10 participants**, extracting **12 actionable insights** that reduced user navigation time by **20%** on a health benefits tool.
- Synthesized research into an MVP roadmap that secured **\$100,000** in funding and consolidated fragmented booking processes.

Projects

Oxygen-Releasing Hydrogel for Diabetic Wounds | Final Year Capstone Project

April 2025

- Led a **4-person team** through project scope definition, stakeholder identification, and success metrics, coordinating weekly team and supervisor meetings that kept all deliverables on **100% schedule completion**.
- Conducted a literature review on oxygen-generating hydrogel systems that helped inform the team's material selection (calcium peroxide-embedded thiolated gelatin), achieving sustained oxygen release validated at **~86%** dissolved oxygen.
- Led social, economic, and sustainability impact analysis, translating technical results into a cost model (**\$0.55–\$8.80/patch**) demonstrating feasibility for equitable deployment in low-resource care settings.